

MONTHLY REVIEW

ISSUE 05

THE STABLECOIN

**The pulse of digital money.
The infrastructure of tomorrow.**

Insights into the capital flows, partnerships, regulation
and infrastructure shaping the stablecoin economy.

This edition covers August 2026.

FEATURE ARTICLE

WHEN THE PAYMENT CANNOT LAND

JUSTIN WANG · CAPITAL LAYER

What Asia's banks stand to lose when the last mile of a stablecoin
payment fails.

\$2.19B

Thirty-seven transactions in a single month — venture rounds, acquisitions, credit facilities and a
twenty-one bank alliance. The full ledger begins on page 25.

**MAIN NEWS
OF THE MONTH**

**REPORTS
& WHITEPAPERS**

**THE ARTICLE
ASIA'S BANKS**

**DEALS
OF THE MONTH**

**DATA HUB
IN NUMBERS**

**EDUCATIONAL
ARTICLES**

**EVENT
CALENDAR**

**FROM THE
EDITOR**



SEPTEMBER 2026

ISSUE NUMBER **05**

THIS ISSUE

A monthly review of the companies, banks, regulators and payment networks building the infrastructure of digital money. This edition covers August 2026.



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FROM THE EDITOR

AUGUST WASN'T ABOUT WHO ISSUES THE DOLLAR. IT WAS ABOUT WHO DELIVERS IT.



For two years the industry measured itself in supply. August measured itself in reach.

Standard Chartered became the first bank distributor of a Hong Kong dollar stablecoin platform. Shinhan Financial agreed with Visa to test issuance, remittance and redemption as one loop. JPMorgan weighed a coin of its own, Revolut prepared a euro stablecoin for its own payment product, and Onafriq carried USDC into more than forty African markets. None of these are issuance stories. They are distribution stories — decisions about whose customers touch digital money, and through which account they already hold.

In the same month, Rain's chief executive said stablecoin payments had reached more than 100,000 merchants without those merchants knowing it. Acceptance is spreading through card rails and checkout flows nobody had to rebuild, which means adoption can now grow faster than awareness of it.

Public money drew its boundaries at the same time. Britain moved to give the Bank of England a formal mandate over stablecoins and digital

money. Washington restated its position — no central bank digital currency, private issuance under the GENIUS Act. BRICS discussed connecting national instant payment systems to CBDCs, and China brought eight more banks into the digital yuan network.

Behind the announcements, the unglamorous half of the stack caught up. ReconArt began reconciling Solana remittances and agentic payments, WasabiCard extended payouts across more than thirty currencies, and Deel started paying a global workforce in stablecoins through Mesh.

And capital followed the rails rather than the tokens. Fasset reached a \$1 billion valuation with SBI behind its payments push, Ripple backed an RLUSD credit fund, and GalaxyOne opened a credit line built on Paxos infrastructure.

The token question is largely settled. The open question is who owns the last mile.

THE WHOLE OF AUGUST IN ONE PLACE

EVERY STORY THAT MATTERED THIS MONTH – BANKS, PLATFORMS,
REGULATORS, CAPITAL AND PAYMENT NETWORKS – READ TOGETHER AS ONE
BRIEFING ON WHO DELIVERS DIGITAL MONEY.



Revolut prepares EURR, a euro stablecoin for its own payment products – a distribution platform issuing for its own base.

THE DISTRIBUTION LAYER

03

By the middle of 2026, the argument about which stablecoin would win had largely exhausted itself. USDT and USDC anchor the market, euro issuance is consolidating under regulation, and a new coin no longer changes the shape of the industry by arriving.

What changed in August was the position of everyone else. Banks, card networks, payroll platforms, wallets, exchanges and reconciliation vendors all moved at once, and they moved on the same axis: distribution. Not who mints the dollar, but whose customers can spend it, in which market, through which account they already have.



Standard Chartered becomes the first bank distributor of HKDAP.

A GLOBAL BANK TOOK THE DISTRIBUTOR'S SEAT — NOT THE ISSUER'S.

Banks Take the Distribution Seat

The month's clearest signal came from Hong Kong. Standard Chartered became the first bank distributor of HKDAP, the Hong Kong dollar stablecoin platform, positioning a global bank between a regulated issuer and real-economy users. Distribution, not issuance, was the role it chose.

South Korea followed with the consumer loop. Shinhan Financial and Visa agreed to jointly test issuance, remittance and redemption together — the first time the full cycle has been framed as one experiment rather than three separate pilots.

In the United States, JPMorgan was reported to be weighing a stablecoin of its own as the bank push accelerated. In the Gulf, Zand expanded stablecoin

access in global markets with USDC. Matera and Utila partnered to help banks bring digital assets to their own customers, and TrustLinq wired Thunes into its settlement network.

These are different strategies with a common assumption: the customer relationship stays with the bank, and the stablecoin becomes a settlement detail behind it. A bank does not need to issue anything to capture the flow — it needs to be the place where the flow lands.

Circle's partner network expanded on the same logic. OpenPayd integrated with the Circle Payments Network, and 1Shot API joined the Circle Alliance Partner Network. What is disappearing is the middle position — the firm that issues a token but controls no distribution and holds no customers.

Public Money Draws Its Boundaries

The month closed with the institutions. The United Kingdom moved to give the Bank of England a formal mandate over stablecoins and digital money — an instruction to accommodate private digital currency rather than resist it.

Washington restated the opposite emphasis. The administration reaffirmed its ban on a central bank digital currency and defended the GENIUS Act,

leaving private issuance as the sanctioned route to a digital dollar.

Elsewhere, public money kept building. BRICS weighed connecting national instant payment systems with CBDCs, and China added eight banks to the digital yuan network, taking operators to thirty.

These are not competing predictions about which form of money survives. They are jurisdictions choosing where the state sits in the settlement chain — issuer, supervisor, or operator of the rails underneath.



Zerohash returns to the OCC for a national trust bank charter.



Licences Become the Product

Regulatory access is now a competitive asset rather than a compliance cost. Zerohash resubmitted its application for an OCC national trust bank charter, seeking the federal footing that would let it serve regulated institutions directly.

RedotPay laid the groundwork for US expansion with its first money transmitter licence, Crossmint secured RPAA and MSB registration in Canada, and HashKey began settling with Hong Kong's first regulated stablecoin — a licence converted into live operations.

Sign and BNB Chain unveiled a sovereign stablecoin framework for national currencies — packaging the regulatory and technical structure itself as a product for states.

Permission determines reach. A licence decides which corridors a company can serve, which banks hold its reserves and which enterprises can legally use it — making chartering strategy as consequential as engineering.

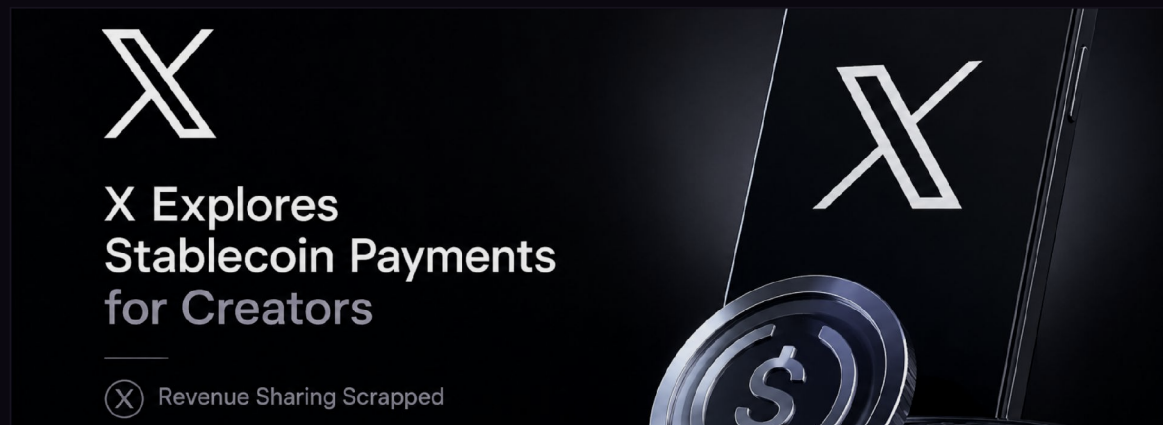
Acceptance Without Awareness

Rain's chief executive said stablecoin payments now reach more than 100,000 merchants without those merchants knowing it. Settlement happens over card rails; the storefront sees an ordinary card transaction.

That is the quietest and most important adoption mechanism in the market. It requires no merchant education, no new terminal and no change in consumer behaviour, which is precisely why it scales.

The consumer edge filled in around it. Anytap shipped a USDT-loaded Visa card aimed at South Korea, Japan and Indonesia. Miracle Pay partnered with Zerohash to switch on stablecoin payments for US merchants. MoonPay brought ctUSD on- and off-ramps live, and Cash App's crypto support expanded beyond bitcoin and USDC through MoonPay.

Getting money in and out remains the real obstacle. Crossmint launched a global onramp, WasabiCard extended payouts across more than thirty fiat currencies, KiiChain added TRON for onchain FX, and EXOPAY kept building a network connecting digital assets to everyday commerce.



X explores stablecoin payouts for creators.

Platforms, Payroll and Agents

Large platforms began fitting stablecoins to their own money flows rather than offering them as a feature. X was reported to be exploring stablecoins to pay influencers and content providers — a payout problem spread across many jurisdictions and small amounts, which is where the instrument is strongest.

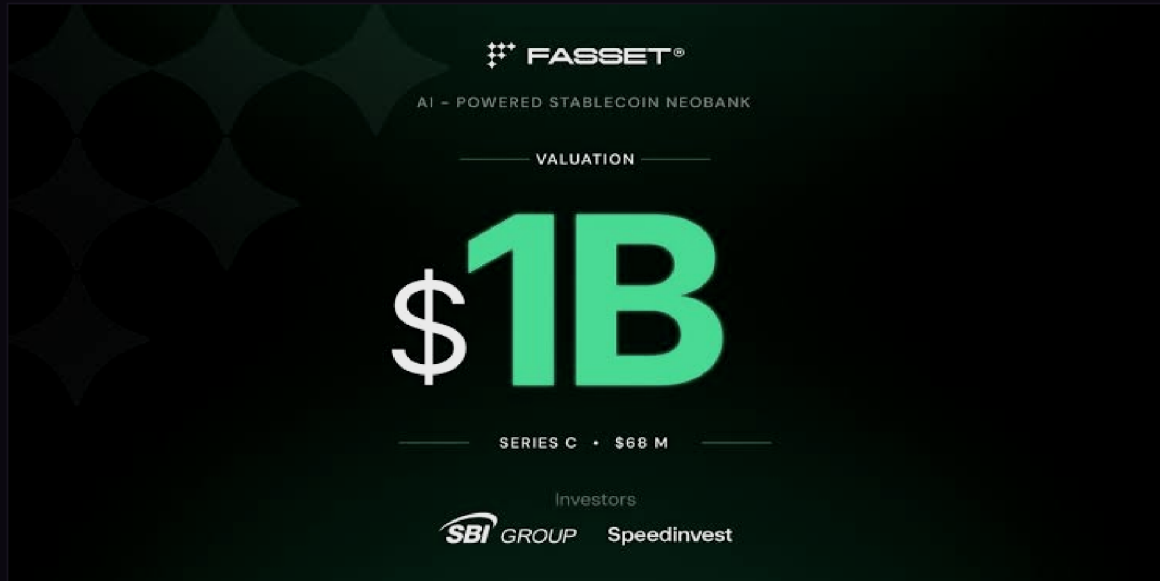
Deel partnered with Mesh to power stablecoin payouts for a global workforce, and Thunes added EURC for instant euro treasury funding.

Agent-driven commerce moved from theory to plumbing. Mastercard's chief executive tied stablecoins directly to AI-agent payments, Rain launched an Agentic Payments Alliance, Payouts.com and the Casper Association partnered on agent payments, and ReconArt integrated with Solana to reconcile stablecoin remittances and agentic payments. Reconciliation is the tell — when accounting vendors build for a payment type, it has become a line item someone has to close at month end.

Capital Moves Toward Credit and Rails

Investment activity tracked the same shift. Fasset, a stablecoin neobank, reached a \$1 billion valuation with SBI backing its payments push — a price

attached to distribution in emerging markets, not to assets under management.



Fasset lands a \$1B valuation with SBI behind its payments push.

Ripple backed an RLUSD credit fund during XRP's strongest week in months, extending a stablecoin into lending rather than payments alone. GalaxyOne launched a crypto portfolio line of credit built on Paxos infrastructure, and Ethena tapped FalconX for institutional stablecoin lending.

Credit is the natural next layer once settlement works. A dollar that moves instantly is useful; a dollar that can be borrowed against instantly changes corporate behaviour.

Volume followed. Blockradar crossed \$1 billion in transaction volume. Circle deployed natively on Plasma, with USDC, EURC and CCTP live there, and

Ondo's USDY went live on Tempo — which OZAV folded into its own infrastructure.

The Corridors Widen South and East

Distribution expanded fastest where banking infrastructure is thinnest. Onafriq integrated Circle's USDC across more than forty African markets, connecting a mobile money network to dollar liquidity at once.

Brydge and Monirates partnered on zero-fee stablecoin wallets, and Flutterwave and Caliza widened payment access across the same region. Fees, not technology, are the competitive variable there.

In Asia, Coins.ph integrated Tempo for high-speed transfers, HashKey and YF Life tested HKDAP for insurance payments, and Eskimo added stablecoin payments for global eSIM plans through Triple-A. Tether's chief executive said USDT adoption is growing in four countries.

Settlement Partners Change Hands

One transaction reframed the competitive map. With BVNK now owned by Mastercard, Visa began looking for a new stablecoin settlement partner — evidence that the card networks consider settlement infrastructure worth owning outright rather than renting.

For the independent infrastructure companies that is both the opportunity and the risk. Being the partner of a card network is the fastest route to global volume, and the shortest route to being acquired by one.

What August Showed

Put the month's announcements side by side and they stop looking like separate news. A bank becomes a distributor. A card network shops for a

settlement partner. A payroll platform pays contractors in dollars that never touch a correspondent bank. A central bank receives a formal mandate. An accounting vendor learns to reconcile agent payments.

None of these are stablecoin stories in the old sense. Not one is about supply, reserves or which token is safest. They are about who carries the money the last mile to a person or a business, and who gets paid for carrying it.

This is the phase where the industry's value moves from the instrument to the network. The issuers remain essential — but so did the mints, long after the banks took over the business of moving what they made.

The next twelve months will test whether the banks, platforms and card networks now entering this layer intend to distribute stablecoins, or to replace them with instruments of their own. August suggested both are underway at the same time.

THE TOKEN RACE IS OVER. THE RACE FOR THE LAST MILE HAS STARTED.

Privacy built into your stack

Add private balances, deposits, withdrawals, payments, and swaps to your product - without changing your custody model, user experience, or tech architecture

 **polygon** **MPCVault** **AllScale** **THE VAULT** **peso** **Borderless.xyz**

Payments

 Dashboard Wallets

Available balance

199,000.00 USDC**Hinkal API**

```
import { useTurnkey } from "@turnkey/react-wallet-kit";
import { TurnkeySigner } from "@turnkey/ethers";
import { ethers } from "ethers";
```

```
const { wallets, httpClient, session } = useTurnkey();
```

```
// A Turnkey wallet can hold several accounts; select the EVM one
const evmAccount = wallets
```

Turnkey

Privy

DFNS

Dynamic

Asset



USDC USD Coin

ACCOUNT	AMOUNT	TOKEN
0x1a5710T...	100	USDC
...	0	USDC

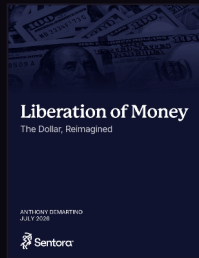
Send privately

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REPORTS & WHITEPAPERS

THIRTY-NINE DOCUMENTS WORTH THE READING TIME THIS MONTH – FROM
CENTRAL-BANK FIELD STUDIES AND LAW-FACULTY WORKING PAPERS TO ISSUER
FILINGS, TRADE-FINANCE ARCHITECTURE AND A BOOK FOR THE WEEKEND.

**THE ARGUMENTS ARE SETTLED. THE
PLUMBING IS NOT.**

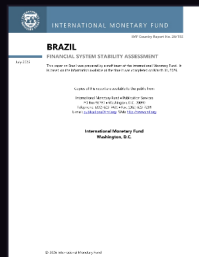


SENTORA RESEARCH · JULY 2026

LIBERATION OF MONEY: THE DOLLAR, REIMAGINED

A blueprint for rebuilding banking on programmable dollars — checking accounts, payroll, lending and card credit rebuilt on stablecoins, yield vaults and smart contracts. Its sharpest number: collateral-backed cards financing balances at roughly 7% instead of 23%.

sentora.com/research/reports

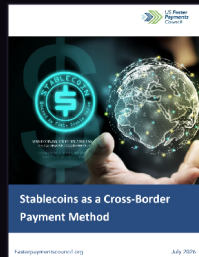


INTERNATIONAL MONETARY FUND · JULY 2026

BRAZIL: FINANCIAL SYSTEM STABILITY ASSESSMENT

IMF Country Report 26/192. The Fund's full FSAP review of Brazil's banking system, prepared by staff on information available to 31 March 2026 — the reference document for anyone underwriting Latin America's largest stablecoin corridor.

[elibrary.imf.org · Country Report 26/192](https://elibrary.imf.org/Country-Report/26/192)

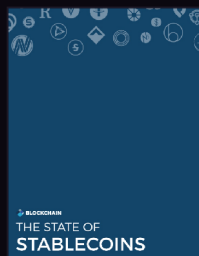


US FASTER PAYMENTS COUNCIL · JULY 2026

STABLECOINS AS A CROSS-BORDER PAYMENT METHOD

Two models for B2B settlement compared: direct wallet-to-wallet transfer versus stablecoins hidden inside the bank's back office. The FPC comes down for the indirect model on compliance clarity and reuse of existing rails. Settlement: 1-10 days becomes same-day.

fasterpaymentscouncil.org · PDF



BLOCKCHAIN.COM RESEARCH · ARCHIVE

THE STATE OF STABLECOINS

The first empirical study of the category: 57 projects, 1,600 data points, 77% asset-backed, Tether holding 93% of a \$3B market. Read it as a time capsule — the taxonomy it built is still the one the industry argues with.

blockchain.com · PDF

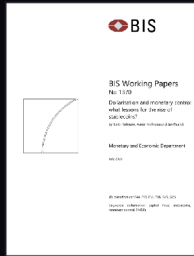


WESTPAC IQ · JULY 2026

THE NEXT EVOLUTION OF DIGITAL MONEY

Written for CFOs, not for crypto. \$180 trillion crosses borders each year and \$330 billion of working capital is lost to B2B payment friction; the report maps four stages from infrastructure build-out to AI agents settling in stablecoins.

westpaciq.com.au · report and PDF



BIS WORKING PAPER 1370 · JULY 2026

DOLLARISATION AND MONETARY CONTROL: WHAT LESSONS FOR THE RISE OF STABLECOINS?

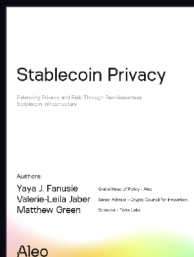
Hofmann, Mehrotra and Paulick compare stablecoin inflows with fifty years of deposit dollarisation across 130+ economies. Same drivers, same stickiness — but capital controls that cut FX deposits by 25–32 points have no measurable effect on stablecoin flows.

bis.org · PDF


STABLECOIN INSIDER · JULY 2026

INTO B2B STABLECOINS

Cross-border payments, KYB compliance and card issuance, produced with Persona, Kulipa and Cybrid. An operator's document rather than an analyst's: what a business stablecoin programme actually has to stand up before it ships.

stablecoininsider.org · registration required


ALEO · WHITEPAPER

STABLECOIN PRIVACY

Yaya Fanusie, Valerie-Leila Jaber and Matthew Green argue that confidentiality and supervision are not opposites: how permissionless infrastructure can balance transaction privacy against illicit-finance risk. Relevant to anyone reading this issue's Hinkal page.

aleo.org · PDF


STABLECOIN BEAT · JULY 2026

STABLECOIN MARKET REPORT

A monthly data brief covering market size and trends, top movers, concentration and peg stability, supply by chain, GENIUS- and MiCA-compliant issuers and yield-bearing tokens. Archived with a DOI, which makes it citable — rare in this category.

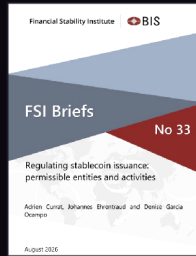
[DOI 10.5281/zenodo.21760956](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21760956)


RIPPLE · REPORT

STABLECOIN COLLECTIONS

Real-world applications driving fintechs and crypto companies, built around the least glamorous and most valuable use case in the category: getting paid. Vendor research, worth reading as a map of where collections volume is actually landing.

ripple.com · registration required

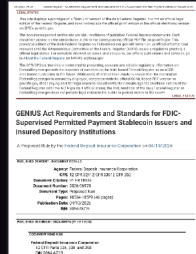


BIS FINANCIAL STABILITY INSTITUTE · AUGUST 2026

REGULATING STABLECOIN ISSUANCE: PERMISSIBLE ENTITIES AND ACTIVITIES

FSI Briefs No 33, by Currat, Ehrentraud and Garcia Ocampo. A cross-jurisdiction comparison of the two questions every licensing regime has to answer first: who is allowed to issue, and what else may that issuer do.

bis.org/fsi · FSI Briefs 33



FDIC · PROPOSED RULE · 2026

GENIUS ACT REQUIREMENTS FOR FDIC-SUPERVISED STABLECOIN ISSUERS

91 FR 18534, 46 pages, amending 12 CFR Parts 324, 330 and 350. The primary source behind every consultant's summary — how a US bank supervisor proposes to actually examine a permitted payment stablecoin issuer.

federalregister.gov · 2026-06974



BROOKINGS · HUTCHINS CENTER WP 113 · AUGUST 2026

STABLECOINS AFTER GENIUS: PRIVATE MONEY, PUBLIC DEBT, AND THE GLOBAL DOLLAR

Nellie Liang and Brent Neiman set out three tradeoffs: cheaper programmable payments against weaker illicit-finance controls, new T-bill demand against a shorter federal debt maturity, and a stronger dollar role against foreign policy pushback.

brookings.edu · paper

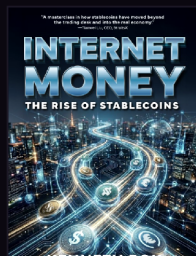


SUMSUB · GUIDE

STABLECOIN COMPLIANCE IN 2026

Which rules apply to your business — a practitioner's walk through the regimes now live across the US, the EU and Asia, and which of them bite depending on whether you issue, custody, distribute or merely accept.

sumsub.com · guide



KENNETH BOK · BOOK

INTERNET MONEY: THE RISE OF STABLECOINS

The long-form version of the story this magazine covers monthly, from the author of Decentralizing Finance, with a foreword by Alex Manson of SC Ventures. The one item here you read on a weekend rather than at a desk.

kennethbok.com · book



ORBITAL · H1 2026 MARKET REVIEW

STABLECOIN RETAIL PAYMENTS INDEX REPORT

A bear-market map of retail usage: where crypto speculation retreated and where utility held. Supply broke through the \$311bn ceiling while active users and transfers grew more convincingly than price did. Emerging-market exchanges now run mostly on USDT, Coinbase mostly on USDC.

getorbital.com/stablecoin-index



ING THINK · 5 AUGUST 2026

STABLECOINS 101: UNCERTAIN GROWTH BUT THE STAKES ARE HIGH

First in a series. Stablecoins reached nearly US\$300bn in market capitalisation at the end of 2025 and still account for only about 7% of the broader crypto market. ING's view: further growth depends on leaving the crypto landscape for the payment world, which needs a regulatory framework and interoperability first.

think.ing.com/article



FLAGSHIP ADVISORY PARTNERS · AUGUST 2026

THE STABLECOIN PROMISE IN CROSS-BORDER PAYMENTS: REAL, BUT NOT UNIFORM

Cross-border remains the most friction-laden, expensive and opaque segment of global finance. Flagship sizes the addressable market use case by use case, illustrates the early ones that are working, and sets out the conditions under which broad adoption will – or will not – materialise.

flagshipadvisorypartners.com/insight



TRUE NORTH PARTNERS · WHITE PAPER · AUGUST 2026

STABLECOINS FOR PAYMENTS: IT'S THE NETWORK STUPID

The argument in the subtitle: the asset is not the product. Value accrues to whoever assembles issuance, distribution, on- and off-ramps and acceptance into a working network – which is why most single-token payment strategies stall before they reach volume.

[truenorthpartners](#) · via LinkedIn

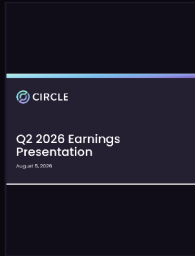


BANCA D'ITALIA · MISP NO. 86 · JULY 2026

ARE STABLECOINS EFFICIENT FOR REMITTANCES?

Di Iorio, Di Stefano, Mascioli and Trebeschi test the claim empirically – by mystery shopping. A central bank actually sending remittances through stablecoin and incumbent channels and comparing what arrived, when, and at what all-in cost. The rare paper with fieldwork instead of estimates.

bancaditalia.it/PDF



CIRCLE · 5 AUGUST 2026

Q2 2026 EARNINGS PRESENTATION

The only listed pure-play issuer reporting to public-market standards. Read the reserve-income disclosure and distribution-cost lines together: they are the clearest available proxy for what the economics of a regulated stablecoin business actually look like at scale.

[investor.circle.com · quarterly results](https://investor.circle.com/quarterly-results)



BLACKROCK · PROSPECTUS · 31 JULY 2026

DAILY REINVESTMENT STABLECOIN RESERVE VEHICLE

BlackRock Funds OnChain Shares, ticker RSVXX — a fund built specifically to hold stablecoin reserves. Not commentary but a filed prospectus: the reserve-management layer of the industry, described in the language of securities regulation rather than of crypto.

blackrock.com · PDF



KPMG CANADA · AUGUST 2026

THE STRATEGIC ROLE OF STABLECOINS AND TOKENIZATION FOR CANADIAN INSTITUTIONS

Considerations and implications for financial system infrastructure, written for a market that has been deliberate rather than fast. Useful outside Canada as a template for how a mid-sized jurisdiction reasons about adopting rails it did not design.

[kpmg.com/ca · insight](https://kpmg.com/ca/insight)



FORRESTER CONSULTING · 2026

HOW FINANCIAL SERVICES LEADERS APPROACH THE STABLECOIN EVOLUTION

A thought-leadership paper commissioned by AWS Marketplace, arguing stablecoins are already reshaping the industry. Survey-based, so treat the enthusiasm with the usual discount — but the questions it asks institutions are the ones boards are now asking internally.

[Forrester · commissioned paper](#)

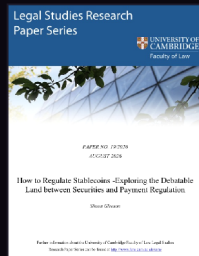


A-TEAM INSIGHT · COMMISSIONED BY APEX

THE INSTITUTIONAL ADOPTION OF STABLECOINS

Strategic value, challenges and implementation frameworks. The framework section is the reason to read it: a sequence for standing up custody, treasury and reconciliation before volume arrives, rather than the usual list of reasons adoption is inevitable.

a-teaminsight.com · registration required

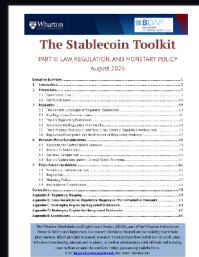


CAMBRIDGE FACULTY OF LAW · PAPER 19/2026 · AUGUST 2026

HOW TO REGULATE STABLECOINS

Simon Gleeson on the debatable land between securities and payment regulation — the question underneath most jurisdictional disagreement. If a token is a claim on a reserve pool, is it an instrument or a payment mechanism? The answer determines which regulator, and which rulebook.

Legal Studies Research Paper Series

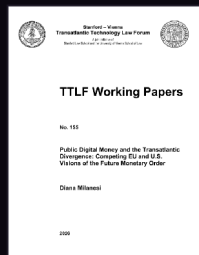


WHARTON BDAP · AUGUST 2026

THE STABLECOIN TOOLKIT, PART II: LAW, REGULATION AND MONETARY POLICY

The most complete reference document in this collection. Private and commercial law, conflict of laws, US and cross-country regimes, the e-money interface, regulatory arbitrage, and a monetary-policy section on reserves, interest, currency competition and the central bank's trilemma — with jurisdictional and bankruptcy mappings in the appendices.

bdap.wharton.upenn.edu · PDF

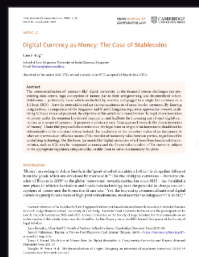


STANFORD-VIENNA TTLF · WORKING PAPER 155 · 2026

PUBLIC DIGITAL MONEY AND THE TRANSATLANTIC DIVERGENCE

Diana Milanese on competing EU and US visions of the future monetary order. Europe builds public digital money and constrains private issuance; the US does the reverse. The paper treats that split as a durable structural fact rather than a phase, and works through what it means for firms operating in both.

law.stanford.edu · TTLF WP 155



ASIAN JOURNAL OF COMPARATIVE LAW · 2026

DIGITAL CURRENCY AS MONEY: THE CASE OF STABLECOINS

Lance Ang compares Singapore and UK approaches and proposes substance over form: what matters is not the technology but whether an instrument effectively transfers monetary value. On that test, payment-like stablecoins bear the characteristics of money and should be recognised as the functional equivalent of fiat — with the safeguards that implies.

doi.org/10.1017/asjcl.2026.10034



THESIS · AUGUST 2026

STABLECOINS IN THE GLOBAL FINANCIAL SYSTEM

A thesis on the structure, regulation and market trajectory of fiat-referenced digital currencies, covering regulation, tokenization, cross-border payments and the future of programmable money. Long-form and unhurried — the closest thing here to a single-volume orientation to the whole subject.

via LinkedIn

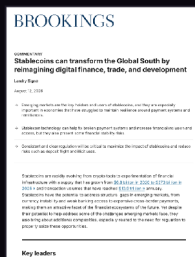


ARTHUR D. LITTLE · VIEWPOINT · 2026

THE SOVEREIGN STABLECOIN ERA: REPLICATION, NOT RESISTANCE

Singh, Nikkar and Takezawa argue the sovereign response was never a binary between resisting the dollar's spread and capitulating to it. From the UAE's dirham-backed DDSC and Brazil's VASP regime to Nigeria's cNGN, Hong Kong's licensing wave and Japan's yen-pegged tokens, states are building their own.

[adlittle.com · viewpoint](https://adlittle.com/viewpoint)



BROOKINGS · 12 AUGUST 2026

STABLECOINS CAN TRANSFORM THE GLOBAL SOUTH

Landry Signé on reimagining digital finance, trade and development. Supply has grown from \$6.8bn in 2020 to \$273bn in 2026 with transaction volumes reaching \$10.9tn annually, and emerging markets are the key holders — which is also why deposit flight and illicit-use risk land there first.

[brookings.edu · commentary](https://brookings.edu/commentary)



RIPPLE · REPORT

STABLECOIN SPOTLIGHT ON AFRICA

Expanding financial utility — vendor research on the continent where the utility case is least theoretical. Worth reading alongside the Brookings commentary: same thesis, opposite vantage point, and a useful check on which corridors are carrying real volume rather than pilot volume.

[ripple.com · registration required](https://ripple.com/registration-required)

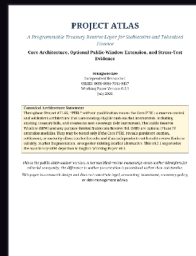


NON-EQUILIBRIUM · ISSUE 11 · AUGUST 2026

THE TOKEN THAT HAD TO FUND THE GOVERNMENT

The product is a programmable dollar; the engine is a portfolio of public debt. An essay on the uncomfortable symmetry of that arrangement, anchored on an estimated \$153bn of stablecoin T-bill reserves as of December 2025 — and on what happens to issuers, and to the bill market, if either side of it moves.

[Non-Equilibrium · via LinkedIn](#)

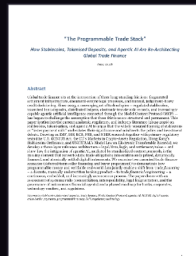


SSRN · WORKING PAPER V0.2.1 · JULY 2026

PROJECT ATLAS: A PROGRAMMABLE TREASURY RESERVE LAYER

Seungwoo Lee proposes a reserve-control and settlement architecture for stablecoins and tokenized finance built on existing eligible cash-market instruments — creating no new sovereign debt instrument. Core architecture, an optional public-window extension, and stress-test evidence. A research design, explicitly not advice.

ssrn.com · abstract 7118484

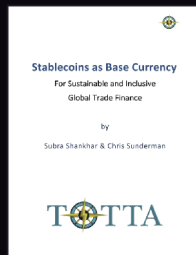


WORKING PAPER · JUNE 2026

THE PROGRAMMABLE TRADE STACK

How stablecoins, tokenised deposits and agentic AI are re-architecting global trade finance. A three-layer reference architecture — legal/data, logic, settlement/value — read against the GENIUS Act, MiCA, Hong Kong's Stablecoins Ordinance and UNCITRAL's MLETR, with two worked trade-finance scenarios.

via LinkedIn



TOTTA · WHITE PAPER

STABLECOINS AS BASE CURRENCY FOR GLOBAL TRADE

Subra Shankar and Chris Sunderman on sustainable and inclusive trade finance — the case for pricing and settling trade obligations in a stablecoin rather than converting through correspondent chains. Written from the trade-finance side of the table, which is rarer than it should be.

Totta · via LinkedIn



RIPPLE · CASE STUDY

SCALING REGULATED STABLECOINS WITH INSTITUTIONAL-GRADE CUSTODY CONTROLS

The operational half of the licensing question. Key management, segregation, mint-and-burn authorisation and audit trails are what a supervisor examines after the licence is granted — and where most issuer programmes discover their controls were designed for a smaller float.

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TEROXX RESEARCH · AUGUST 2026

THE STATE OF STABLECOINS MID-YEAR 2026

Consortium money, public markets and the regulatory status — a half-year stocktake covering the bank-led consortium issuers, the listed vehicles now exposed to the category, and where each major regime stands. The most convenient single catch-up if you have read nothing since January.

teroxx.com/research

WHAT ASIA'S BANKS STAND TO LOSE WHEN A STABLECOIN PAYMENT CANNOT LAND

Why a settlement gap most banks deprioritise ends with treasury moving offshore.

BY JUSTIN WANG · FOUNDER & CEO, CAPITAL LAYER

The servers behind the AI buildout are assembled in Asia. The money for them travels the other way — and has started arriving in a form their banks cannot accept.

The servers behind the AI buildout are assembled in Asia and shipped to data centres elsewhere. The money for them travels in the opposite direction, along correspondent banking rails the exporting countries do not control, and it has started arriving in a form their banks cannot accept.

A manufacturer takes an order for AI hardware. The buyer wants to settle in US dollar stablecoins. The goods ship on schedule, the counterparty is real, the

invoice is real. What stops working is the part that used to be automatic: the money landing in the manufacturer's own account, at its own bank, in its own country.

That gap is small, procedural, and easy for a bank to deprioritise. It is also where a bank starts to lose a corporate client.

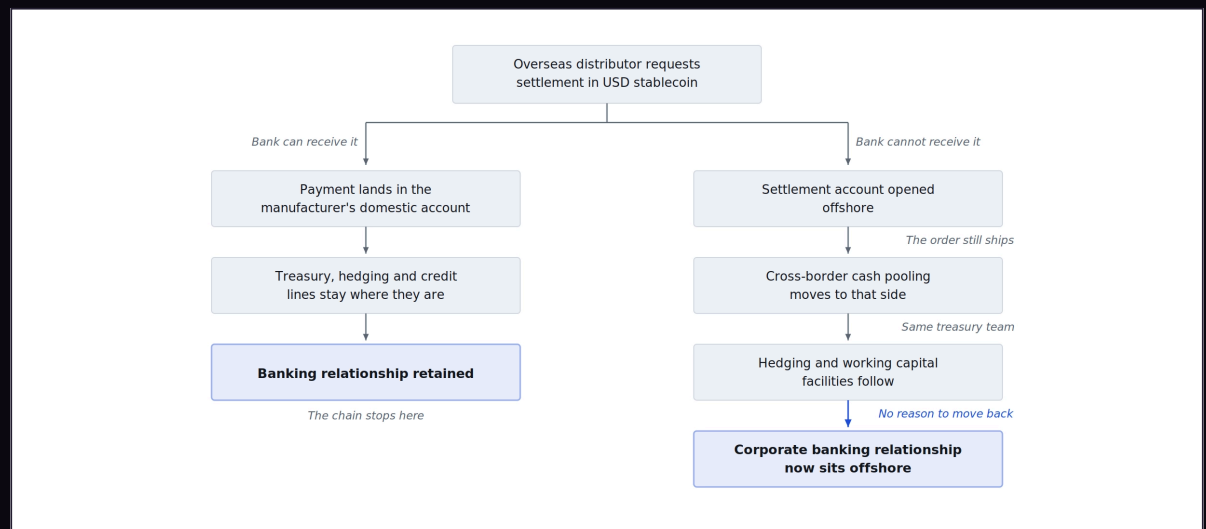


Figure 1. The delay is the trigger, not the loss. Both paths begin with the same request and the same shipped order. What separates them is whether the domestic bank can receive the payment.

The Request Manufacturers Are Already Fielding

Since last year, our conversations with semiconductor and electronics manufacturers in Taiwan have surfaced the same request repeatedly: overseas distributors, mostly in Latin America and in the Singapore and Hong Kong corridor, asking to settle in US dollar stablecoins. Their domestic banks cannot yet receive and book that payment, so some of these manufacturers have opened settlement accounts offshore.

That is what we see in one market rather than a survey finding, but the surveys point the same way. In TAITRA's October 2025 trade index, based on a survey conducted that September, 47.7 percent of Taiwanese enterprises regarded stablecoins as a cornerstone of future trade settlement, with only 20 percent unsure. Actual adoption remains early: around 10 percent qualify as early adopters, 5.2 percent already using stablecoins and 4.2 percent planning to, with higher rates among Taiwanese firms operating overseas. Demand is validated. Adoption is not yet built.

Why a Bank Cannot Simply Take the Stablecoin Payment

The obstacle is not that a bank cannot see a blockchain transaction. Four things have to be true before a bank can accept one on behalf of a corporate client, and few banks have all four in production today.

It needs a custody arrangement its board has reviewed and signed off. It needs a compliance function that can screen these counterparties and survive a regulatory examination. It needs settlement logic that reconciles with its core banking systems, so a client's balance and reporting behave normally. And it needs an interface its operations team can work in without touching a blockchain directly.

That is not a systems upgrade. It runs across business operations, compliance, information security and internal audit at once, which is why the honest answer to "why has this not happened yet" is that it is genuinely hard, not that banks are asleep. Taiwan is a useful illustration: the primary legislation has passed, but the subsidiary regulations that would tell an institution exactly what it is building toward have not been issued yet.

Why Faster Settlement Is the Weakest Reason to Care

It is tempting to frame this as latency. Cross-border transfers routed through correspondent banks typically take several business days to arrive, and three to four is what we see in the corridors we work in. Stablecoin settlement can compress that toward same day.

That framing understates the problem.

Manufacturers work on 30, 60 and 90 day payment terms that have already absorbed several days of settlement lag. Nobody reorganises their banking relationships to save three days on an invoice that is not due for two months.

The pull is structural, and it operates on two levels.

The first is corporate treasury. When a manufacturer's overseas subsidiaries can pool cash across currencies in real time, settle between entities without waiting on a correspondent chain, and turn receivables into financing collateral the same day, the treasurer does not move one payment. The treasurer moves the cross-border accounts, then the hedging, then the working capital facilities that sit alongside them. What the domestic bank loses is not a wire fee. It is the corporate banking relationship, and relationships that relocate for structural reasons do not relocate back for sentimental ones.

NOBODY REORGANISES THEIR BANKING RELATIONSHIPS TO SAVE THREE DAYS ON AN INVOICE THAT IS NOT DUE FOR TWO MONTHS.

The second is bank to bank. Regulated stablecoins let interbank settlement run without depending on a chain of overseas branches and correspondent

relationships. That is the larger market, and it is where the question of which institutions remain settlement nodes actually gets answered.

Why the AI Corridor, and Why Now

Any export economy could tell a version of this story. Taiwan's is the most concentrated, because of what it exports and to whom. Taiwan produced more than 90 percent of the world's advanced AI chips as of the most recent assessment, and AI-related goods accounted for 43 percent of global goods trade growth in the first half of 2025.

In 2025, Taiwan's exports to the United States grew 78 percent year on year and accounted for 30.9 percent of total exports, in a year when the AI buildout pushed the trade surplus to 157 billion dollars, close to double the year before.

The market question is not speculative either. Citi Institute's *Stablecoins 2030* report projected the stablecoin market growing from roughly 300 billion

US dollars at the time of that report to 1.9 trillion by 2030, with a bull case of 4 trillion.

Regulation has largely arrived. The United States completed the GENIUS Act in 2025. Taiwan's Virtual Asset Service Act passed its third reading on 30 June 2026, bringing stablecoins under financial supervision and establishing that financial institutions go first; the subsidiary regulations have not yet been issued, and the act is expected to take effect in the first half of 2027 at the earliest. Singapore, Hong Kong and Japan have each published or implemented their own frameworks.

Which leaves a timing problem that is easy to miss. Enterprise demand is happening in 2026, and the banks we see assessing this work are scheduling proof of concept for around the first quarter of 2027. That gap is where corporate relationships change hands.



Figure 2. The window is not the regulation, it is the lag behind it. Rules and enterprise demand are both arriving now, while the banks assessing the work are scheduling proof of concept for around the first quarter of 2027.

The Strongest Case for Banks Moving Slowly

The honest counter-argument is that banks are right to be slow, and it deserves stating properly rather than dismissed.

A bank that moves early and gets custody boundaries or screening obligations wrong will find that error considerably more expensive than a year of waiting. Liability allocation, operational cost and the risk that the regulation an institution

built toward shifts underneath it are all real. Institutions that are audited, questioned and relied upon are supposed to behave this way.

Where the argument holds is execution risk, and where it stops holding is sequencing, because waiting until the subsidiary regulations land means beginning the multi-department work at the moment the market has already allocated the relationships. The cost of that timing is paid in franchise rather than in project budget.

THE COST OF WAITING IS PAID IN FRANCHISE, NOT IN PROJECT BUDGET.

Why Stablecoins Scale Through Banks, Not Around Them

Most writing about stablecoins assumes disintermediation – that the interesting outcome is the one where banks get routed around. In Asia, the deployments that scale are the ones running inside banks, because of who the counterparties are. A listed manufacturer will generally not hold operating cash outside a regulated banking relationship, because its auditors, lenders and board are unlikely to permit it. Compliance

frameworks, custody arrangements and existing credit lines are not obstacles to route around. They are the reason a corporate treasurer says yes at all.

That is where the gap sits. Issuance, custody, compliance and settlement each have capable specialists. What has been thin in Asia is the layer that lets a bank connect what it already runs to stablecoin infrastructure, rather than assembling and maintaining the pieces itself.

What Capital Layer Does for a Bank

This is the work Capital Layer does. A bank that wants to serve corporate clients here should not have to assemble and maintain the parts itself, and our role is to let it run this inside the systems, controls and approval chains it already operates.

One boundary matters more than any feature, and we hold it deliberately: keys and assets stay in the bank's own environment, under the bank's control. The bank is the custodian. We provide the technology, not the custody. For an institution that will be audited on this, that distinction is the whole conversation.

The consequence a bank should care about is positional rather than operational. An institution that can settle in this form stops being one that routes through someone else's correspondent chain and becomes one that other institutions can connect to. In a region where several markets are deciding this at the same time, that is a difference in standing, not just in product.

ABOUT CAPITAL LAYER

Capital Layer is a Digital Asset Orchestration Layer for banks and enterprises in Asia, giving banks the ability to receive, convert and settle stablecoin payments for their corporate clients inside the systems, controls and approval chains they already operate — so stablecoin settlement becomes a capability an institution adds rather than a platform it has to build.

Keys and assets remain in the bank's own environment, under the bank's control. The bank is the custodian; Capital Layer provides the technology rather than the custody.

Working with banks and enterprises in Asia, starting in Taiwan. capitalayer.com

Whether the approach survives contact with a live banking environment is a fair question, and the answer so far is partial. A Taiwanese commercial bank has completed a cross-border settlement proof of concept with us, converting into Japanese yen, run in a test environment using test tokens. It was a verification exercise, not a production launch, and no client funds or mainnet assets were involved. It tells us the integration path works. It does not yet tell us the business does, and we would rather say that plainly than imply otherwise.

If the argument here is right, the signal to watch over the next year is not another round of pilot announcements. It is the first Asian bank moving this into limited production for corporate clients, and the first annual reports showing manufacturers' cross-border banking arrangements quietly relocating to the jurisdictions that settled their position early.

Justin Wang is Founder & CEO of Capital Layer. He works with banks and manufacturers across Asia on cross-border stablecoin settlement.

SOURCES

Taiwan's 2025 trade surplus nearly doubles amid AI-driven demand — ING Think, 9 January 2026.

Stablecoins 2030 — Citi Institute Global Perspectives & Solutions, September 2025.

TAITRA Trade Index, October 2025 (survey conducted 10 September 2025).

Taiwan Semiconductors Guide — U.S. International Trade Administration, 2024.

Global Trade Outlook and Statistics — WTO, 7 October 2025.

GENIUS Act and Taiwan Virtual Asset Service Act status — public legislative record; third reading 30 June 2026, subsidiary regulations pending.

Distributor settlement requests, bank readiness timing and the proof of concept — Capital Layer's own observations and work.

WHERE THE MONEY WENT

FUNDING ROUNDS, ACQUISITIONS AND CREDIT FACILITIES – CAPITAL MOVING INTO DISTRIBUTION, LICENSING AND SETTLEMENT RAILS RATHER THAN INTO TOKENS.

**CAPITAL STOPPED PRICING TOKENS. IT
STARTED PRICING DISTRIBUTION.**

INVESTMENT & M&A REVIEW

EQUITY WROTE THE SMALL CHEQUES. CREDIT WROTE THE BIG ONES.

TRANSACTIONS

37

Across six categories

DISCLOSED CAPITAL

\$2.19B

August 2026

DEBT SHARE OF CAPITAL

69%

\$1.51B of \$2.19B

August produced **37 disclosed transactions** and roughly **\$2.19B** of identified capital across venture, strategic investment, M&A, debt, fund formation and one bank consortium. The count looks ordinary. The composition does not.

Venture capital was the busiest category with twenty rounds, but those rounds carried only \$229.5M between them — an average cheque under \$12M. Equity is being written in seed and Series A sizes for wallets, agent payments, prediction-market plumbing and regional stablecoin rails.

M&A stayed small in count and structural in intent. eToro paid up to \$231M for TradeZero, BitGo took NYDIG's institutional trading book, Circle bought IBM's blockchain patent portfolio, and Payward absorbed Magic Labs' embedded-wallet business. None of these were bought for users; all four were bought for capability.

The money itself moved through credit. Four debt and credit facilities accounted for **\$1.51B**, 69% of the month's disclosed capital: FalconX's \$1B secured lending vehicle against USDe liquidity, \$275M of senior notes at Ripple Prime, Félix's \$200M equity-and-credit package for WhatsApp remittances, and Galaxy's \$30M AUD facility settled onchain. Stablecoin balance sheets are now being financed like balance sheets.

The clearest signal came from institutions rather than investors. Cari's bank-owned Layer 2 raised \$32.5M from seven US banks, and twenty-one global banks — Bank of America, Citi, Goldman Sachs, UBS, Deutsche Bank and Santander among them — announced a joint company to issue a regulated dollar stablecoin. When incumbents start funding the rails together, the competitive question stops being which token wins and becomes who owns the settlement layer.

VENTURE CAPITAL · AUGUST 2026

TWENTY ROUNDS, ONE AVERAGE CHEQUE OF \$12M.

VENTURE CAPITAL DEALS · \$7.5M AND ABOVE

11 OF 20 DEALS · \$210M

COMPANY	AMOUNT	ROUND	FOCUS
Fasset	\$68M	SERIES C	Stablecoin neobank for emerging markets; round led by SBI Group.
Sapiom	\$35M	SERIES A	Production infrastructure, wallets and programmable payment controls for autonomous AI agents.
OpenReserve	\$25M	SEED	Cashless 24/7 digital national bank in the US, plus the rUSD stablecoin.
InvestiFi	\$20M	FUNDING ROUND	Embedded digital-asset trading and stablecoin access for credit unions and community banks.
NeoSoul	\$11M	SERIES A	Credentials and execution layer for autonomous AI agents.
Diameter Pay	\$10M	SERIES A	API infrastructure for virtual USD accounts and stablecoin gateways for banks.
Dow Protocol	\$9M	SEED	Onchain working-capital financing against e-commerce receivables.
River Markets	\$8.5M	SEED · YC P26	Prime-brokerage and execution infrastructure across prediction-market venues.
Beldex	\$8M	FUNDING ROUND	Privacy-preserving DeFi infrastructure.
Firelight	\$8M	SEED	Collateral-backed cover protocol for smart-contract exploits and DeFi risk.
Entravel Group	\$7.5M	FUNDING ROUND	Programmable payment, settlement and distribution infrastructure for travel.

The top of the table is a distribution story. Fasset's \$68M Series C funds a stablecoin neobank for emerging markets, OpenReserve's \$25M seed pairs a 24/7 digital bank with its own rUSD, and InvestiFi's \$20M puts digital-asset trading inside credit unions and community banks. All three sell access rather than issuance.

Diameter Pay raises \$10M in the same lane from the other side: virtual USD accounts and stablecoin gateways for banks, through an API.

The second cluster is autonomous software. Sapiom's \$35M Series A and NeoSoul's \$11M Series A both fund wallets, credentials and spending controls for AI agents, a payer type that did not appear in any deal table a year ago.

Notably absent at this end of the market: new issuers. Not one round above \$7.5M went to launching another dollar token.

VENTURE CAPITAL · CONTINUED

THE SMALL END IS WHERE THE NEW USE CASES ARE.

VENTURE CAPITAL DEALS · UNDER \$5M

9 OF 20 DEALS · \$19.45M

COMPANY	AMOUNT	ROUND	FOCUS
Pilot Protocol	\$4.5M	SEED	USDC wallets and payment infrastructure for autonomous agents.
Birdai Labs	\$4M	SEED	Onchain trade-execution infrastructure that returns execution value to users.
ORO	\$3M	STRATEGIC ROUND	AI-driven DeFi execution platform.
Plenti	\$3M	SEED	Multi-currency accounts expanding from Colombia into Peru and Bolivia.
Reental	\$1.7M	FINANCING ROUND	Tokenized real-estate investment and distribution across 100+ countries.
ParlayX	\$1.25M	PRE-SEED	Institutional trading terminals for prediction markets.
Polaris	\$1M	ANGEL ROUND	pETH, a yield-bearing collateral asset for decentralised stablecoins.
BLOX	\$1M	SEED	Malaysian stablecoin infrastructure built around the ringgit-backed MYRC.
RWA.xyz	Undisclosed	SEED	Data, analytics, compliance and investment infrastructure for tokenized real-world assets.

Table 2. Remaining disclosed venture rounds, ranked by size. Nine deals share \$19.45M — pre-seed and seed capital for agent wallets, prediction-market tooling, tokenized property and regional stablecoin rails.

Two themes run through the month’s venture activity. The first is agents: Pilot Protocol here, alongside Sapiom and NeoSoul on the previous page, all raised to give autonomous software its own wallets, credentials and spending controls — infrastructure for a payer that does not hold a card.

The second is geography. BLOX in Malaysia, Plenti across the Andes and Rental in tokenized property are building local rails on dollar and ringgit settlement, at cheque sizes a bank would not notice and in corridors a bank does not serve.

STRATEGIC INVESTMENT & CONSOLIDATION

NOBODY BOUGHT USERS. EVERYONE BOUGHT CAPABILITY.

STRATEGIC INVESTMENTS

7 DEALS · \$118.1M DISCLOSED

COMPANY / TRANSACTION	AMOUNT	TYPE	FOCUS
ROD Clearing	\$74M	STRATEGIC INVESTMENT	Equities clearing and tokenization infrastructure.
Cari	\$32.5M	BANK CONSORTIUM	Bank-owned Ethereum L2 for tokenized commercial deposits; seven US banks including First Horizon, Huntington, KeyBank and M&T.
MemeBitcoin	\$8M	STRATEGIC ROUND	Infrastructure for the Bitcoin ecosystem; led by Gemhead Capital.
GAEA	\$3.6M	STRATEGIC ROUND	Decentralised AI infrastructure connecting data, compute and autonomous agents.
Ripple / ZILO™	Undisclosed	PARTNERSHIP	Digital transfer-agency and fund-servicing infrastructure for traditional and tokenized products.
Ripple / Licuido	Undisclosed	PARTNERSHIP	Tokenized-asset issuance and collateral infrastructure using RLUSD as the cash leg.
Concrete Protocol	Undisclosed	PARTNERSHIP	Onchain credit and structured-debt appchain.

MERGERS & ACQUISITIONS

4 DEALS · \$288.5M DISCLOSED

ACQUIRER / TARGET	AMOUNT	TYPE	FOCUS
eToro / TradeZero	Up to \$231M	ACQUISITION	Active-trading and brokerage infrastructure for eToro's push into US professional trading.
BitGo / NYDIG	\$57.5M	ACQUISITION	NYDIG's institutional trading business.
Circle / IBM	Undisclosed	PATENT PORTFOLIO	Blockchain intellectual property supporting stablecoin payments and digital-asset infrastructure.
Payward / Magic Labs	Undisclosed	ASSET ACQUISITION	Embedded-wallet business integrated with trading, custody, tokenized assets and settlement.

Strategic money clustered around clearing, tokenized deposits and settlement plumbing rather than issuance. Ripple alone accounted for two of the month's partnerships, both aimed at fund servicing and collateral — the unglamorous middle of asset management, with RLUSD as the cash leg.

The acquisitions read as capability purchases: a professional trading platform, an institutional trading book, a patent portfolio and an embedded-wallet team. Consolidation in this market is now about completing a stack, not buying a customer base.

DEBT, FUNDS AND INSTITUTIONAL ALLIANCES

\$1.51B OF CREDIT — AND TWENTY-ONE BANKS IN ONE COMPANY.**DEBT FINANCING & CREDIT**

4 DEALS · \$1.505B DISCLOSED

COMPANY	AMOUNT	TYPE	FOCUS
FalconX / Ethena Labs	\$1B	SECURED LENDING SPV	Vehicle channelling USDe liquidity into institutional credit.
Ripple Prime	\$275M	SENIOR NOTES	Senior unsecured notes funding prime-brokerage expansion.
Félix	\$200M	EQUITY + CREDIT	\$87M equity and a \$113M facility for WhatsApp-based remittances on USDC and Stellar.
K3 Capital / Galaxy	\$30M	ONCHAIN CREDIT FACILITY	AUSD-denominated institutional lending, verifiable onchain.

FUND FORMATION

1 DEAL · \$50M

FUND	AMOUNT	TYPE	FOCUS
Psalion	\$50M	VENTURE FUND III	Investment capacity for blockchain infrastructure and applications.

INSTITUTIONAL ALLIANCE

21 BANKS · ANNOUNCED SEP 1

ENTITY	PARTICIPANTS	TYPE	FOCUS
Interbank Consortium	21 banks	JOINT VENTURE	Bank of America, Citi, Goldman Sachs, UBS, Deutsche Bank, Santander and fifteen others forming a joint company to issue a regulated USD stablecoin on public blockchains.

Credit is the finding of the month. When a lending vehicle can raise \$1B against stablecoin liquidity and a facility can be drawn, deployed and verified onchain, the asset has stopped being a settlement token and started behaving like collateral inside a financing structure.

Fund formation stayed modest — a single \$50M vehicle — which fits a month where capital came from balance sheets and bank consortia rather than from new

venture pools.

Taken together, August's 37 transactions describe an industry financing its own infrastructure: small equity cheques for the software, large credit lines for the money, acquisitions for the missing pieces, and banks funding the rails they intend to settle on.

STABLECOIN DATA HUB

THE MONTH IN NUMBERS – SUPPLY, VOLUME, LIQUIDITY AND PAYMENT ACTIVITY
ACROSS NETWORKS, VENUES AND CARD PROGRAMMES.

**SUPPLY TELLS YOU WHO HOLDS THE
DOLLARS. VOLUME TELLS YOU WHO USES
THEM.**

THE MONTH IN FOUR NUMBERS

SUPPLY BARELY MOVED. TURNOVER MOVED 55%.

TOTAL SUPPLY \$314.7B +1.3% vs 30D ago	AVG DAILY VOLUME \$235.6B +55.3% vs prev 30D	AVG DAILY TRANSACTIONS 68.4M +9.2% vs prev 30D	AVG DAILY ACTIVE ADDRESSES 4.7M +2.9% vs prev 30D
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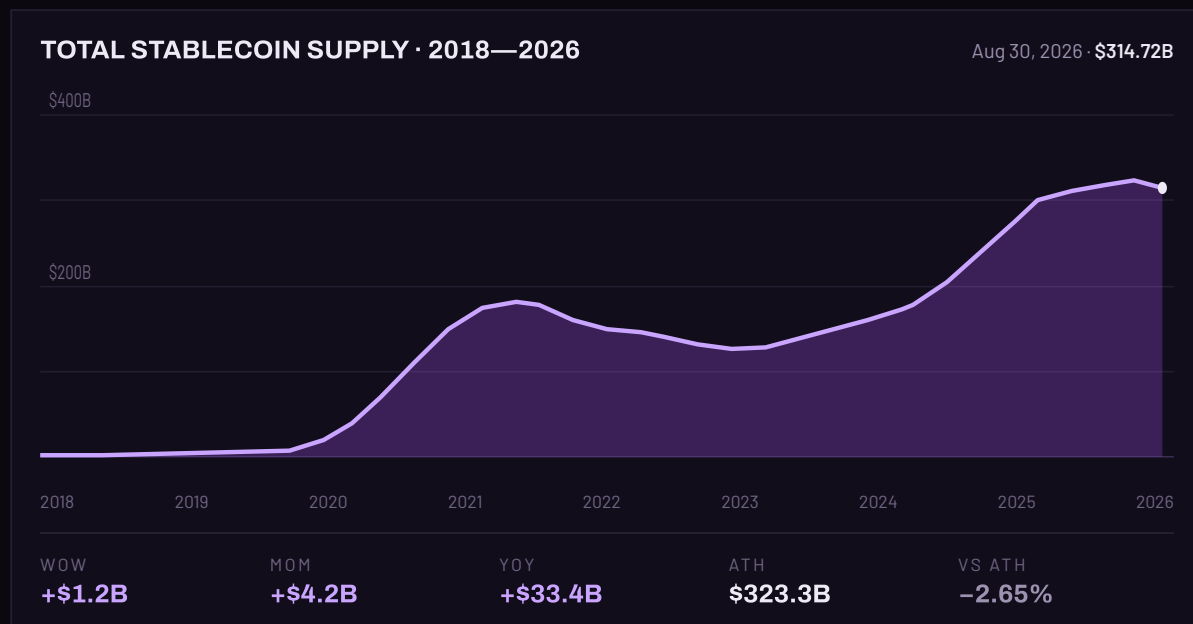


Figure 3. Eight years of supply, one month of turnover. The curve that took until 2025 to clear \$200B now sits \$8.6B below its all-time high while daily volume runs at three-quarters of the entire float. Source: Artemis, as of Aug 30, 2026.

August was not a growth month. Supply ended at **\$314.7B**, up 1.3% over thirty days and still 2.65% short of the March all-time high of \$323.3B. Measured year on year the float added \$33.4B – respectable, but the shape of the month says the issuance cycle has paused.

What did not pause was usage. Average daily volume reached **\$235.6B**, a 55.3% jump on the previous thirty days, against transaction growth of only 9.2% and active-address growth of 2.9%. Volume rose six times faster than the number of people moving it.

That gap is the story of the month. The same wallets are moving materially larger tickets – the signature of treasury, market-making and settlement flow rather than retail. A float that stops growing while its turnover accelerates is a float being put to work.

Read against the eight-year curve, the plateau looks less like a stall than a change of phase. Every previous leg up came from new issuance chasing new holders; this one comes from existing balances circulating faster. Velocity, not float, is now the metric that moves – and it is the one bank treasurers will be asked about first.

WHO HOLDS THE DOLLARS

TWO TOKENS, 82.4% OF THE MARKET.

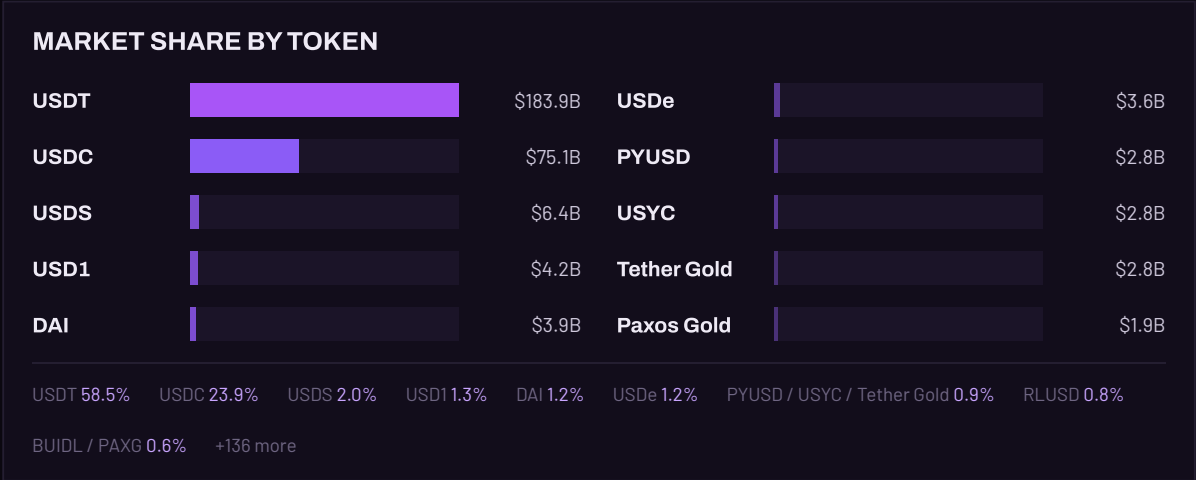


Figure 4. Bars scaled to USDT. The 136 tokens outside the top twelve share roughly 4% of the float between them. Source: Artemis, Aug 30, 2026.

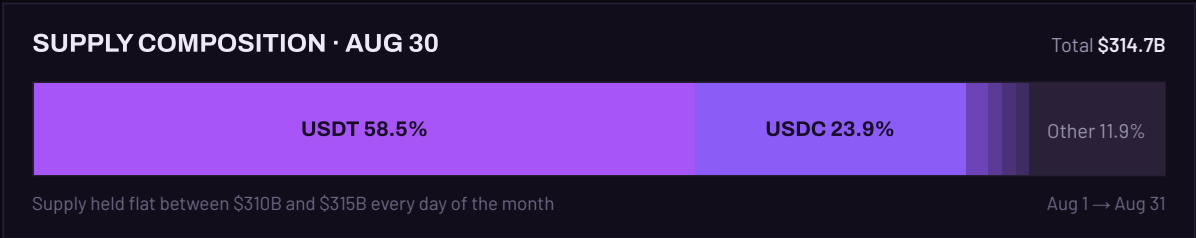


Figure 5. Daily composition was effectively unchanged for 31 days — no issuer gained or lost a full percentage point of share. Source: Artemis.

Tether ended August holding **\$183.9B**, or 58.5% of all stablecoin value. Circle held \$75.1B at 23.9%. Between them: 82.4% of the market, unchanged in shape from the start of the month.

Everything below is small enough to be a rounding error on the leaders. USDS at \$6.4B and USD1 at \$4.2B are the largest challengers; DAI, USDe, PYUSD and USYC each sit near \$3B. The regulated newcomers that dominated the news cycle have not yet shown up in the float.

Two gold-backed tokens — Tether Gold at \$2.8B and Paxos Gold at \$1.9B — now rank inside the top twelve, a reminder that the category is quietly widening beyond the dollar even while the dollar's share of it stays fixed.

The stability is itself the finding. Through a month of licence announcements, bank pilots and new issuer launches, not one token gained or lost a full percentage point of share. Distribution deals signed in August will show up in this table in 2027, not in 2026 — issuance moves on the timescale of balance sheets, not press releases.

WHERE THE DOLLARS SIT, WHERE THEY MOVE

ETHEREUM CUSTODIES IT. BASE TURNS IT OVER.

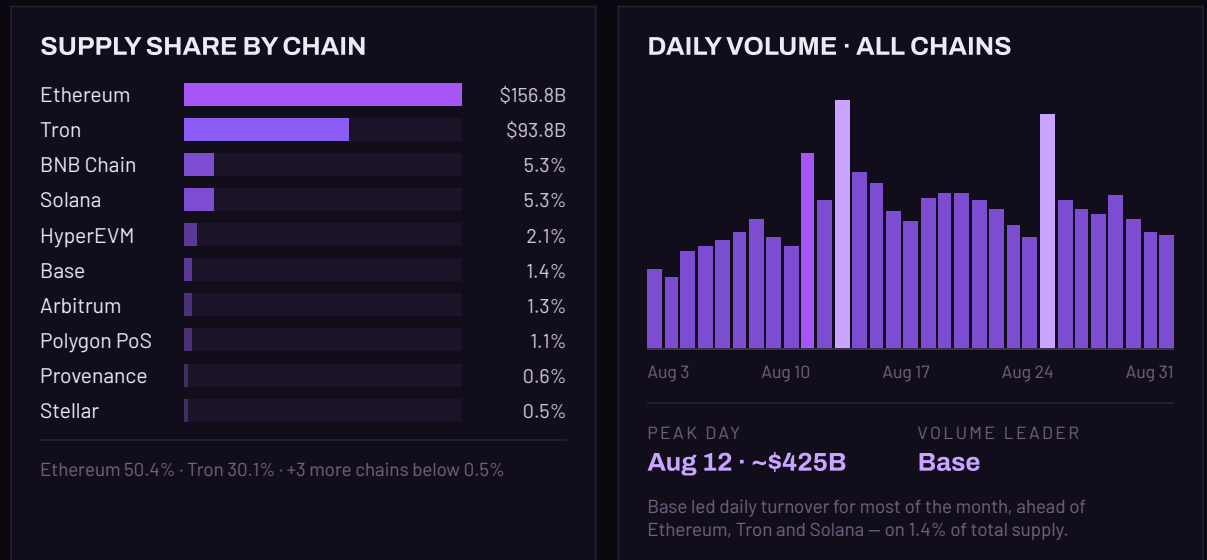


Figure 6. Supply share (left) against daily settled volume (right). Two spikes above \$400B on Aug 12 and Aug 24 carried the monthly average. Source: Artemis.

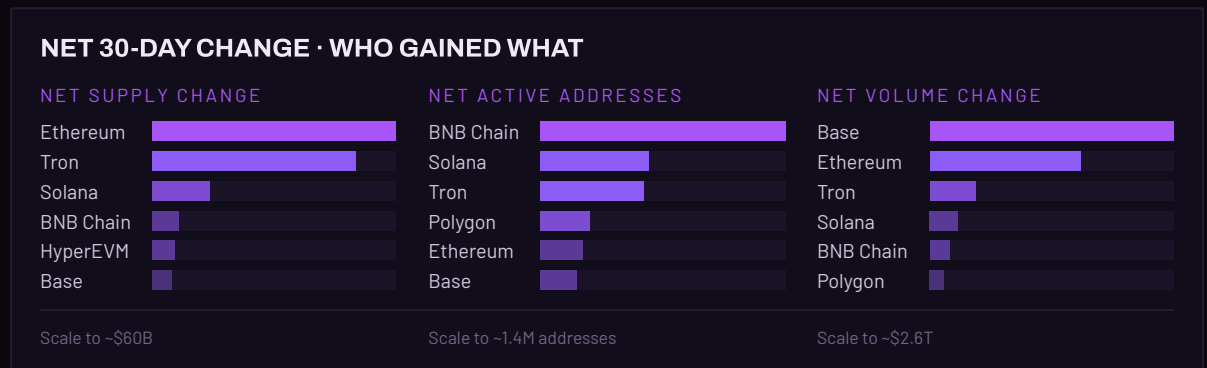


Figure 7. Three different winners: Ethereum took the new balances, BNB Chain took the new users, Base took the new turnover. Source: Artemis, 30-day net change to Aug 30.

Ethereum holds **\$156.8B**, half of all stablecoin value, and Tron another \$93.8B. Together they custody 80.5% of the float — a balance sheet split that has barely changed in two years.

Movement tells a different story. Base, with 1.4% of supply, led daily volume for most of August and posted the largest net volume increase of any chain. BNB Chain added the most active addresses. The chains that store the dollars and the chains that move them are no longer the same list.

LIQUIDITY AND GEOGRAPHY

ONE VENUE CLEARS HALF THE FLOW. TWO REGIONS SEND IT.

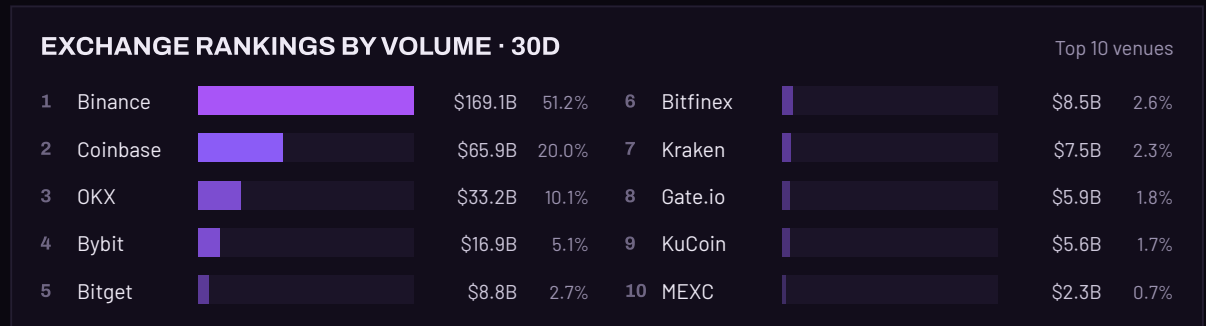


Figure 8. Binance and Coinbase clear 71.2% of exchange stablecoin volume between them; the remaining eight venues share 28.8%. Source: Artemis, 30 days to Aug 30, 2026.

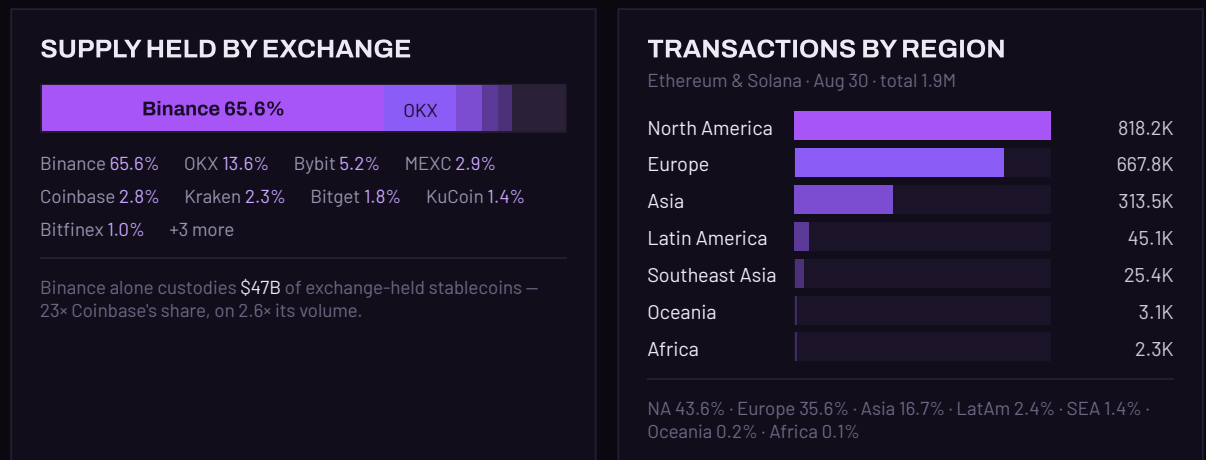


Figure 9. Custody concentration (left) and transaction geography (right). Europe's share climbed from roughly 41% to a 68% intraday peak on Aug 23 before settling at 35.6%. Source: Artemis.

Exchange liquidity is more concentrated than issuance. Binance cleared **\$169.1B** — 51.2% of all venue volume — and holds 65.6% of exchange-custodied supply. Coinbase is second on volume at \$65.9B but holds only 2.8% of the balances: a venue people trade through rather than park in.

Geographically the month stayed transatlantic. North America and Europe accounted for 79.2% of transactions on Ethereum and Solana; Asia contributed 16.7%. Africa, the region most often named in adoption

narratives, registered 2,300 transactions — 0.1%. The regulatory buildout across Hong Kong, the Gulf and Nigeria is real, but it has not yet reached the ledger.

Put the three views together and August resolves into one sentence: the dollars sit with two issuers, on two chains, at one venue, and they move between two continents. Every structural change announced this month — bank distribution, new licences, card programmes — is an argument about which of those concentrations breaks first.

THE STABLECOIN PLAYBOOK

STABLECOINS ARE NOT JUST ASSETS — THEY ARE INFRASTRUCTURE IN MOTION.
SIX LAYERS SHAPING THE NEXT GENERATION OF FINANCE.

01

PRIVACY MATTERS

Beyond hiding transaction amounts

02

ENTERPRISE PAYMENTS

Shielded settlement for real-world business

03

CROSS-BORDER TRANSFORMATION

Faster, cheaper and more transparent

04

TOKENIZATION INFRASTRUCTURE

Built for scale, security and trust

05

THE EVOLVING PROVIDER LANDSCAPE

From blockchain choice to infrastructure choice

06

REGULATORY REALITY

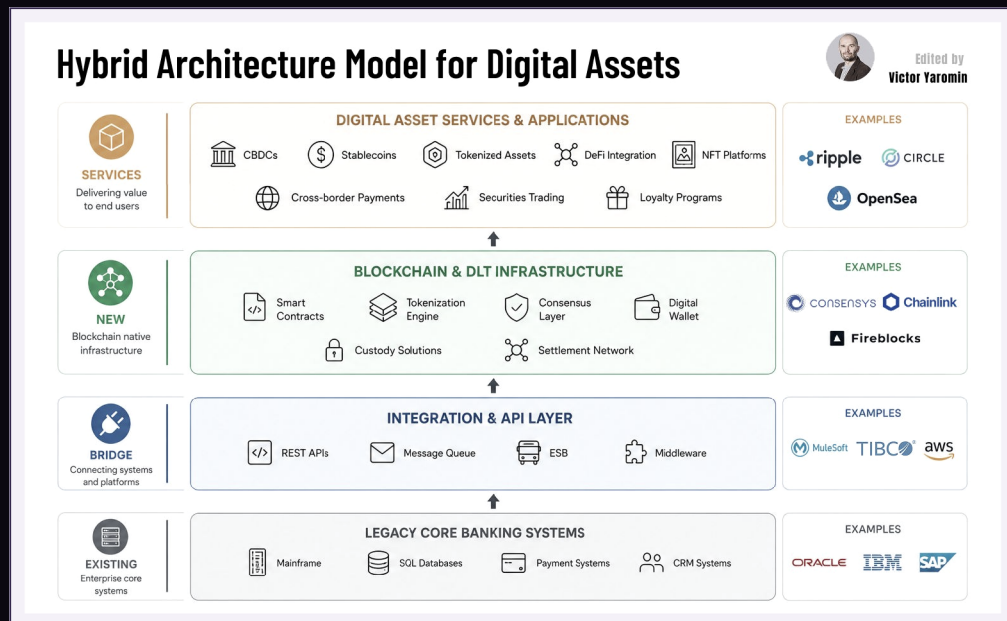
Governance, controls and long-term trust

**IT'S NOT JUST ABOUT STABLECOINS. IT'S
ABOUT THE SYSTEMS BEING BUILT AROUND
THEM.**

ARCHITECTURE · THE HYBRID BANK

NOBODY SWITCHES TO BLOCKCHAIN. THEY REPLACE ONE SERVICE AT A TIME.

Every bank asks the same question: how do we add digital assets without rebuilding what we already have? The answer is an architecture that assumes the core stays exactly where it is.



Four layers: existing core systems, an API bridge, blockchain infrastructure, and the services customers actually see. Source: Victor Yaromin.

Core banking, payment engines, CRM platforms and databases took decades to build and billions of dollars to fund. They are not going anywhere. Any model that begins by discarding them is a model no institution will buy.

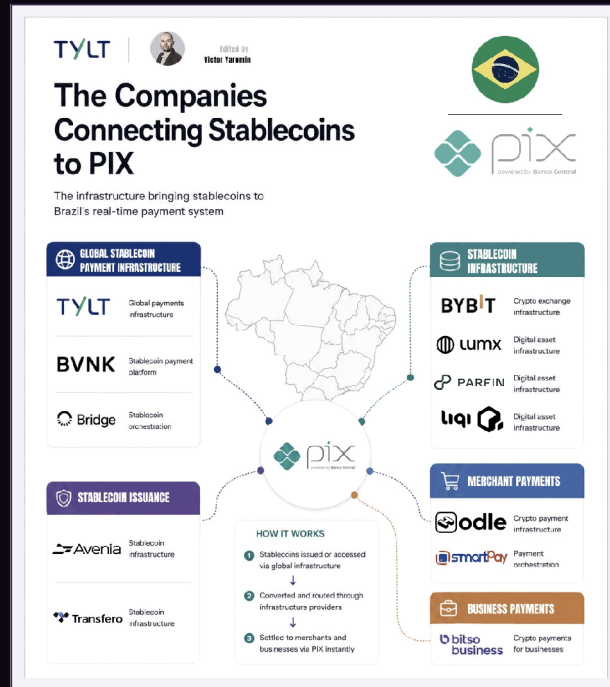
The interesting work happens in the middle. That is where APIs connect old systems to new infrastructure — one side still speaking traditional banking, the other speaking wallets, tokenization, smart contracts and digital settlement. Most institutions are somewhere in between, and the bridge layer is what lets them stay there without breaking anything.

There will be no morning when banks announce they have switched to blockchain. Migration happens one service at a time: cross-border payments first, then tokenized deposits, then collateral, treasury, digital securities. Every year another piece moves across while everything else keeps running as usual.

Follow that path for five years and nobody calls the architecture hybrid any more. A payments service here, a settlement process there — eventually the stack has changed, even if the logo on the building never does. It will just be banking.

BRAZIL · STABLECOINS AND PIX

STABLECOINS WON'T REPLACE PIX. THEY'LL SIT UNDERNEATH IT.



The layers forming around PIX: global payment infrastructure, digital asset providers, local issuers, merchant orchestration and business payments. Source: Tylt, edited by Victor Yaromin.

Stablecoins are coming to PIX — but probably not in the way many people expect. The interesting part is not stablecoins replacing Brazil's instant payment rail. It is the infrastructure being built around it to connect global stablecoin liquidity to a domestic real-time system.

The ecosystem is already taking shape. Global payment infrastructure — Tylt, BVNK, Bridge — sits at the entry point. Digital asset and exchange infrastructure providers handle custody and conversion. Local issuers such as Avenia and Transfero mint against the real. Merchant payment and orchestration platforms handle acceptance, and business payment providers close the loop for corporates.

The common layer is DIX, connecting those different pieces to Brazil's instant payment rails. That connector, not the token, is the product.

Stablecoins do not necessarily need to compete with local payment systems. They can sit beneath them — handling liquidity, FX, settlement and cross-border movement — while PIX remains the rail the payer actually touches. The consumer experience does not change; the plumbing behind it does.

That division of labour is what makes the model exportable. Every country with a functioning instant payment system has the same gap: domestic

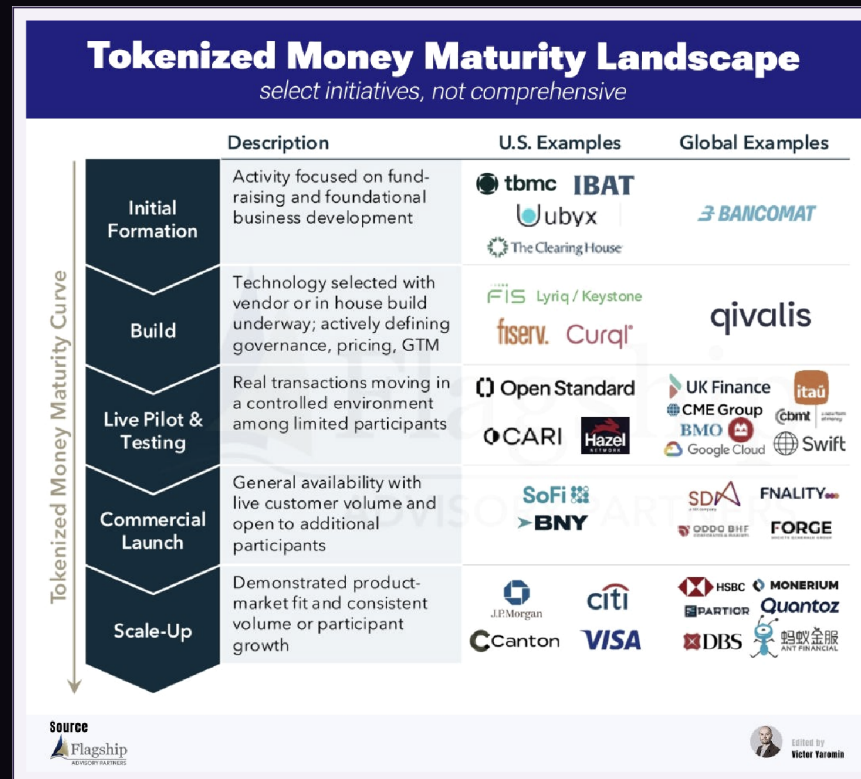
settlement is solved, cross-border liquidity is not. Stablecoins fill the second without disturbing the first.

The next phase of adoption probably looks like this. Not "crypto payments" as a separate experience, but stablecoins becoming invisible financial infrastructure behind payment systems people already use. Brazil could become the clearest example of that model.

MATURITY · TOKENIZED MONEY

THE PILOTS ARE OVER. SOME OF THIS IS ALREADY TRYING TO SCALE.

A year or two ago almost every tokenized money project looked like an experiment — a pilot, a proof of concept, a press release. This picture feels different.



Select initiatives placed along the maturity curve, US and global. Source: Flagship Advisory Partners, edited by Victor Yaromin.

Some initiatives are still working out governance and commercial models. Others are already processing real transactions. And a handful have quietly reached the point where they are no longer trying to prove the technology — they are trying to scale it. That is a very different conversation.

The other thing worth noticing is who shows up at the bottom of the chart. J.P. Morgan. Citi. Visa. HSBC. DBS. Five years ago those names would not have appeared

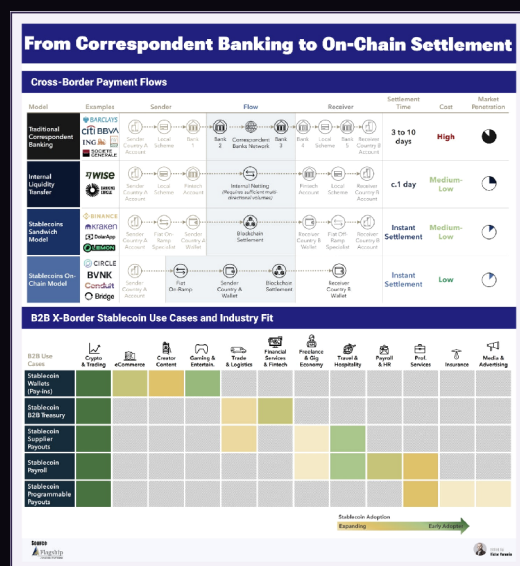
on a slide like this. Today they are helping define what tokenized money looks like in practice.

The next milestone probably will not be another announcement or another pilot. It will be the moment businesses use tokenized money without thinking about it. Nobody asks which database their bank runs, or which cloud processes a card payment. Tokenized money will disappear into the infrastructure the same way — which is what successful financial technology does. It stops feeling like new technology.

CROSS-BORDER · SETTLEMENT

FROM CORRESPONDENT BANKING TO ON-CHAIN SETTLEMENT

3–10 d **~1 d** **Instant**
CORRESPONDENT INTERNAL STABLECOIN



Four settlement models compared, and where B2B stablecoin use cases are landing by industry. Source: Flagship Advisory Partners, edited by Victor Yaromin.

For decades, moving money across borders meant moving through layers of banks, correspondent networks and local schemes. Each hop adds an intermediary, a fee, a cut-off time and a pool of pre-funded liquidity sitting idle in a nostro account. The cost is not only the spread charged to the payer — it is the working capital the system as a whole has to keep parked in advance.

Stablecoins do not remove those steps so much as move where settlement happens. Instead of routing value through a chain of correspondents, the transaction runs from a local fiat account into a stablecoin, across a blockchain, into a receiving wallet, and back out into local currency. The chart opposite compares four versions of that journey.

Traditional correspondent banking takes three to ten days at high cost. Internal liquidity transfer — the model used by Wise and Banking Circle — nets flows inside one balance sheet and lands in about a day. The sandwich model wraps a blockchain leg between two ramp specialists. The full on-chain model keeps the value in a wallet end to end and settles instantly at the lowest cost.

On paper the ranking is obvious. In practice, market penetration still runs in the opposite direction.

The reason is that blockchain settlement is the easy part. The difficulty is everything around it — FX pricing, on and off-ramps, compliance, licensing in each corridor, and a local banking partner willing to hold the account at the far end. A rail that settles in seconds still waits on a payout bank that opens at nine.

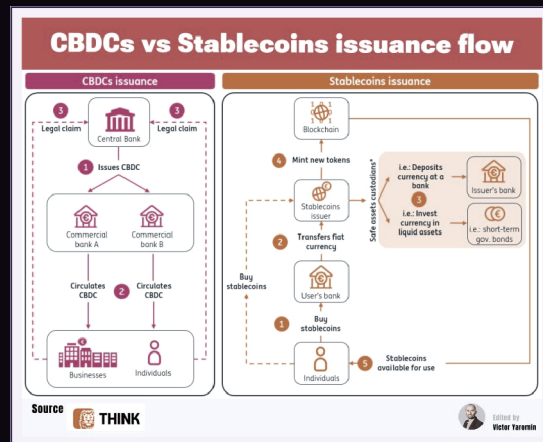
That is why the next stage of adoption looks less like replacing banks and more like connecting existing financial systems through new settlement rails. The bank keeps the customer, the account and the regulatory relationship. The stablecoin layer moves the value underneath, where the customer never sees it.

The use cases are already spreading beyond crypto trading. Treasury movements, supplier payouts, payroll for distributed teams, merchant settlement and programmable disbursements all sit closer to the early-adopter end of the second chart — payments that are high-frequency, cross-currency and low-tolerance for a three-day wait.

Expect cross-border to become increasingly hybrid rather than replaced. The question worth asking is no longer whether stablecoins displace correspondent banking. It is how much of correspondent banking gets quietly rebuilt around on-chain settlement — and how much of it nobody bothers to rebuild at all.

ISSUANCE · CBDCS VS STABLECOINS

WRONG QUESTION: WHICH ONE WINS. RIGHT QUESTION: WHO ISSUES, AND HOW IT MOVES.



Two issuance models side by side: central bank through commercial banks, versus user, issuer, reserves and mint. Source: ING Think, edited by Victor Yaromin.

The debate around CBDCs and stablecoins usually collapses into a single question: which one wins. The more useful question is how the money is actually issued, and what has to happen before it moves.

With a CBDC, the central bank sits at the centre of issuance. It issues into the banking system, commercial banks circulate the money onward, and businesses and individuals hold a direct legal claim on the central bank. The chain is short and every link in it is already regulated.

The stablecoin model runs the other way round. A user buys the token, fiat moves to the issuer, reserves are placed with a bank or invested in short-term government paper, and new tokens are minted on a blockchain. The claim is on the issuer, and the quality of that claim depends entirely on what sits in the reserve.

Two models. Two different control points – and two very different answers to who bears the risk.

That difference in structure is also a difference in speed. CBDC issuance inherits the governance of public money: mandates, accountability, and a distribution path that runs through supervised institutions. Stablecoin issuance inherits the speed of a private balance sheet – a token can exist minutes after the fiat lands, and reach a wallet on the other side of the world minutes after that.

Neither property is universally better. One is what you want for domestic money that has to be legally certain and universally accepted. The other is what you want when value has to cross a border on a Sunday night.

Which is why the market is unlikely to resolve into a head-to-head contest. The two are drifting toward different parts of the payment stack: stablecoins moving value across borders and between platforms, CBDCs and tokenized deposits carrying regulated domestic money and settling between institutions.

If that holds, the next phase is not about replacement. It is about the interfaces between the two worlds – where a stablecoin leg hands off to a central bank rail, and who is accountable at the seam. The race is no longer over which form of digital money exists. It is over who can make digital money move most efficiently.

EVENT CALENDAR

STABLECOIN CONFERENCE CALENDAR

THE MOST COMPREHENSIVE STABLECOIN CONFERENCE CALENDAR FOR 2026 AND 2027, COVERING EVENTS ACROSS NORTH AMERICA, EUROPE, ASIA, THE MIDDLE EAST AND AFRICA.

18

CONFERENCES

15

CITIES

5

REGIONS

**EIGHTEEN CONFERENCES. FIVE REGIONS. ONE
INDUSTRY DECIDING WHO SETTLES.**

NORTH AMERICA

Stablecon USA 2026

SEP 9-11, 2026 · NATIONAL HARBOR RESORT,
WASHINGTON, D.C.

The flagship edition of Stablecon, set in D.C. for proximity to policy. The agenda focuses on regulatory frameworks, issuer positioning, and institutional integration pathways for stablecoins in the US market.

stablecon.com/usa

Sibos 2026

SEP 28 – OCT 1, 2026 · MIAMI BEACH CONVENTION
CENTER, MIAMI BEACH, FL

Swift's annual gathering of the global financial services community. The 2026 theme is "Digital Finance for AI-driven Economies," with sessions on tokenization, ISO 20022, cross-border payments, and how new forms of money integrate with existing rails.

sibos.com

Money20/20 USA

OCT 18-21, 2026 · THE VENETIAN, LAS VEGAS, NV

The largest fintech event in North America. Banks, payments companies and tech giants converge for four days of dealmaking around stablecoin frameworks, FedNow adoption, open banking, and the collision of crypto rails with mainstream finance.

us.money2020.com

Fintech Meetup 2027

FEB 22-24, 2027 · MANDALAY BAY, LAS VEGAS, NV

A meeting-driven event built around 50,000+ scheduled one-on-one conversations between banks, credit unions, fintechs and investors. The 2026 agenda framed stablecoins as payments infrastructure rather than speculation, with sessions on B2B and cross-border use cases.

fintechmeetup.com

Bitcoin 2027

JUL 15-17, 2027 · MUSIC CITY CENTER, NASHVILLE, TN

The world's largest Bitcoin conference returns to Nashville. Expect technical workshops on the Lightning Network, deep dives on Bitcoin Layer-2s, institutional adoption sessions, and major macro and policy keynotes.

b.tc/conference

EUROPE

MERGE Madrid 2026

OCT 27-29, 2026 · MADRID STOCK EXCHANGE & PALACIO
DE CIBELES, MADRID

The European edition of MERGE, drawing 3,000+ attendees and 200+ speakers. A strong institutional lens connecting Spanish and Iberian banks, regulators and Web3 builders. Sponsors regularly include Visa, PayPal, Circle, Tether, Paxos and Bridge.

mmerge.io/merge-madrid-2026

Solana Breakpoint 2026

NOV 15-17, 2026 · OLYMPIA LONDON, LONDON,
UNITED KINGDOM

Solana's flagship conference makes its London debut. Expect major ecosystem announcements, with a focused push to attract European institutional capital, family offices, and the legal infrastructure that defines global capital markets.

solana.com/breakpoint

ASIA & MIDDLE EAST

Global Fintech Fest 2026

SEP 9-11, 2026 · JIO WORLD CONVENTION CENTRE, MUMBAI, INDIA

The world's largest fintech festival, with 100,000+ attendees. Built around India's digital public infrastructure model, with sessions on how stablecoins, tokenization and CBDCs fit alongside real-time payment rails like UPI.

globalfintechfest.com

Money20/20 Middle East

SEP 14-16, 2026 · RIYADH EXHIBITION & CONVENTION CENTER, RIYADH

The Middle East edition of Money20/20, capitalizing on Saudi Vision 2030 and Gulf fintech ambitions. Themes include open banking in MENA, government-driven fintech initiatives, CBDCs and Islamic finance.

money2020middleeast.com

Korea Blockchain Week 2026

SEP 29 - OCT 1, 2026 · WALKERHILL HOTELS & RESORTS, SEOUL

Asia's leading digital asset conference, with Upbit as main sponsor. The 2026 edition opens with a private institutional forum for policymakers and senior industry leaders, followed by main programming on institutional adoption and AI integration.

koreablockchainweek.com

TOKEN2049 Singapore 2026

OCT 7-8, 2026 · MARINA BAY SANDS, SINGAPORE

The world's largest crypto event, taking over all five floors of Marina Bay Sands. Expect 25,000+ attendees, 300+ speakers, and broad coverage of stablecoins, RWAs and payments through the lens of regulated market infrastructure.

token2049.com/singapore

Hong Kong FinTech Week 2026

NOV 2-6, 2026 · HK CONVENTION & EXHIBITION CENTRE, HONG KONG

Asia's premier finance and technology gathering with 45,000+ attendees. The agenda covers tokenization, digital assets, programmable money rails, and Hong Kong's role as a regulated hub between East and West.

fintechweek.hk

Singapore FinTech Festival 2026

NOV 18-20, 2026 · SINGAPORE EXPO, SINGAPORE

One of the world's largest fintech gatherings, organized by the Monetary Authority of Singapore. Expect explicit programming on digital assets, tokenization, and building a new payment settlement layer with stablecoins and tokenized deposits.

fintechfestival.sg

Bitcoin MENA 2026

DEC 7-8, 2026 · ABU DHABI, UAE

The largest Bitcoin conference in the Middle East. Two days of programming on regional adoption, infrastructure and Bitcoin's role across MENA markets, headlined by global Bitcoin leaders and regional policymakers.

mena.b.tc

ASIA & MIDDLE EAST - CONTINUED

Abu Dhabi Finance Week 2026

DEC 7-10, 2026 · ABU DHABI, UAE

The region's flagship financial gathering, hosted by ADGM. The 2025 edition convened decision-makers representing \$62 trillion in assets. Sessions span tokenization, digital assets, sovereign capital, and the architecture of trust for institutional adoption.

adfw.com

TOKEN2049 Dubai 2027

APR 21-22, 2027 · MADINAT JUMEIRAH, DUBAI, UAE

The Middle East edition of TOKEN2049, postponed from 2026. Expects 15,000+ attendees from 4,000+ companies and 160+ countries, with a unique indoor-outdoor format covering everything from regulation to institutional adoption to retail Web3.

token2049.com/dubai

Money20/20 Asia 2027

APR 27-29, 2027 · QUEEN SIRIKIT NATIONAL CONVENTION CENTER, BANGKOK

Asia's premier fintech event, drawing 4,000+ senior decision-makers across banking, payments, fintech and policy. The Intersection stage spotlights TradFi-DeFi convergence, while Policy20 brings central bankers and regulators into structured public-private dialogue.

asia.money2020.com

AFRICA

Africa Stablecoin Summit 2026

NOV 12-13, 2026 · JOHANNESBURG, SOUTH AFRICA

The continent's first dedicated stablecoin summit, themed "Stablecoins at Scale: Institutional Adoption & Financial Infrastructure." Built for central bank governors, commercial bank C-suites, corporate treasurers and stablecoin issuers driving Africa's digital finance buildout.

africastablecoinsummit.io

NEXT ISSUE OCTOBER 2026

September in review: the first banks moving stablecoin settlement into limited production, and what the Q4 conference season puts on the record.

Have a report, a deal or a correction for the next edition? Send it over — contributions are credited.

WHERE STABLECOINS BECOME INFRASTRUCTURE



VIKTOR YAROMIN

EDITOR · THE STABLECOIN

Catch the freshest features. Updated daily, read anytime, anywhere.

Contact me for any questions — reports, deals, corrections and contributions for the next issue are always welcome, and always credited.

This issue covered August 2026: banks becoming distributors, licences becoming products, and the last mile becoming the market.

MY LINKEDIN

[linkedin.com/in/viktor-yaromin](https://www.linkedin.com/in/viktor-yaromin)



SCAN ME

CONTACT ME FOR ANY QUESTIONS

@viktorgyugo